

Hunter Brown  
AdK Residency Programme at the Studio for Electroacoustic Music  
Work Samples

These work samples demonstrate my ongoing engagement with psychoacoustics, digital mediation, machine listening, and the latent perceptual behavior of acoustic and synthetic sound materials.

*Phenomenon #1*, four soprano saxophones & fixed-media (2020)

**Score Follower Video:** <https://youtu.be/6MRRyroA0k0?si=cptNfyVh4E9PnvNQ>

**Audio:** <https://on.soundcloud.com/uVjEUey44tFjrvffpt>

**Score:** <https://www.hunterbrownsound.com/docs/phenomenon1.pdf>

*Phenomenon #1* uses four soprano saxophones as a composite mechanism for directly activating the human hearing apparatus. The saxophone material was recorded and processed through a collection of corrupted audio codecs. The process for corrupting these codecs severely mangles the psychoacoustic algorithms embedded within each codec. When these codecs process audio that contain explicit psychoacoustic phenomena, they produce sounds that challenge universalized notions of auditory perception, while stretching the boundary of what the listener's ear is capable of.

*Derivatives*, stereo fixed media (2024)

**Converge:** <https://samplify.app/p/1eWvBCOPeox33OfwlTat?si=LjdLyzc30ccN5T42lKEf4tl0XEw1>

**[systems]:** <https://samplify.app/p/epIh3hl4BPowbCs7dTHj?si=LjdLyzc30ccN5T42lKEf4tl0XEw1>

**Full Piece:** <https://samplify.app/p/fPq3uafxnfhEGCjzDHID>

*Derivatives* is a work that explores the disjunctions between human and machine auditory perception. It juxtaposes real-world sound objects with their computational abstractions and synthetic digital representations, guiding the listener's ear toward the boundary between the real and the simulated. This is explored through field recordings taken in Buenos Aires and Chicago, AI-synthesized speech, and machine-listening based manipulation of these materials.

This work premiered at the [2024 Festival Nueva Ópera](#) in Buenos Aires as part of a multimedia dance performance. *Derivatives* was also a finalist in the [Prix CIME 2025 Electroacoustic Music Competition](#).

*Stoppages Vol. 1* [∞], stereo & multi-channel fixed media (2023)

**Stoppages Vol. 1, excerpt:** <https://alwayspartyperfect.bandcamp.com/track/stoppages-1-002>

**Stoppages Vol. 1, excerpt:** <https://alwayspartyperfect.bandcamp.com/track/stoppages-1-003>

**Stoppages Vol. 1, complete:** <https://alwayspartyperfect.bandcamp.com/album/pp-03>

*Stoppages Vol. 1* is a collection of unedited recordings synthesized by a digital feedback circuit that exposes the material limitations of a computer's CPU. Every piece of data generated, stored, or received by a computer is physically represented as an electrical charge within a piece of silicon. Like any other physical material, silicon has a finite amount of change it can handle at a given moment. This digital

circuit asks a silicon constructed microprocessor to output an audio signal of a size and intensity that this CPU cannot physically reproduce. In turn, the CPU reaches a physical limit, a stoppage. This stoppage allows the computer's sonic identity to emerge, a state of hysteresis where fractures and discontinuities are amplified and brought to the ear's attention as a result of the CPU's physical inability to reproduce this audio data. This music exposes the material collapse of a silicon microprocessor pushed to its limit. The duration of each track is the length of time the code ran before crashing.

**Stoppages Vol. 2**  stereo & multi-channel fixed media (2024)

**Stoppages Vol. 2, excerpt:** <https://alwayspartyperfect.bandcamp.com/track/stoppages-2-005-1-010>

**Stoppages Vol. 2, excerpt:** <https://alwayspartyperfect.bandcamp.com/track/stoppages-2-018-1-006>

**Stoppages Vol. 2, complete:** <https://alwayspartyperfect.bandcamp.com/album/pp-10-stoppages-vol-2>

**Stoppages Vol. 2** investigates the material nature of digital audio through manipulations of the MP3 codec. Digital audio file formats are representations of sound that mediate between physical data stored on a hard drive and the acoustic signal perceived by a listener. The MP3 employs perceptual audio coding, an encoding process that intentionally discards information deemed “perceptually irrelevant” by psychoacoustic models of human hearing. This process alters the audio's quality as it mediates between the machinic representation of audio and the listener, reducing file size to facilitate reproduction and distribution.

Embedded within this process is an assumed universal mode of listening and perception where timbral delicacy, Western tonality, and naturality are paramount. For example, Suzanne Vega's “Tom's Diner” was one of the sonic benchmarks for tuning the MP3, embedding its sonic characteristics in how the MP3 listens to, interprets, and processes audio [1]. Like vinyl records or cassette tapes, MP3s mediate auditory experience, but unlike their analog predecessors, the MP3's arcane perceptual techniques impose a set of obfuscated sonic ideals upon the listening experience through algorithmic means.

This collection of twenty compositions renders techniques that intervene in and subvert the MP3's perceptual coding process. One approach involves processing sounds whose qualities are diametrically opposed to those that the MP3 is designed to preserve. Given the distinctly digital character of *Stoppages Vol. 1*, that work serves as the source material for *Vol. 2*; bracketed track titles indicate their origins. Other techniques directly alter the psychoacoustic models within the codec itself. These manipulations turn the MP3 into a generative process that reorients the ear beyond the MP3's supposed universal mode of listening and towards an alternative listening, where something other emerges from the latent properties of this standardized format.

[1] For more on the MP3 codec and the role of “Tom's Diner” and other audio samples, see Jonathan Sterne's *MP3: The Meaning of a Format*